



Note: *The draft you are looking for begins on the next page.*

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Most forms and publications have a page on IRS.gov: [IRS.gov/Form1040](https://www.irs.gov/Form1040) for Form 1040; [IRS.gov/Pub501](https://www.irs.gov/Pub501) for Pub. 501; [IRS.gov/W4](https://www.irs.gov/W4) for Form W-4; and [IRS.gov/ScheduleA](https://www.irs.gov/ScheduleA) for Schedule A (Form 1040), for example, and similarly for other forms, pubs, and schedules for Form 1040. When typing in a link, type it into the address bar of your browser, not a Search box on IRS.gov.

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Form **2441**Department of the Treasury
Internal Revenue Service

Name(s) shown on return

Child and Dependent Care Expenses

Attach to Form 1040, 1040-SR, or 1040-NR.

Go to www.irs.gov/Form2441 for instructions and the latest information.

OMB No. 1545-0074

2026Attachment
Sequence No. **21**

Your social security number

A You can't claim a credit for child and dependent care expenses if your filing status is married filing separately unless you meet the requirements listed in the instructions under Line A. If you meet these requirements, check this box ☐

B If you or your spouse was a student or was disabled during 2026 and you're entering deemed income of \$250 or \$500 a month on Form 2441 based on the income rules listed in the instructions under *If You or Your Spouse Was a Student or Disabled*, check this box ☐

Part I Persons or Organizations Who Provided the Care—You must complete this part.If you have more than three care providers, see the instructions and check this box ☐

	Provider 1	Provider 2	Provider 3
1a Care provider's name			
1b Address (number and street)			
Apt. no.			
City or town			
State or province			
ZIP or foreign postal code			
1c Identifying number (SSN or EIN)			
1d Was the care provider your household employee in 2026? For example, this generally includes nannies but not daycare centers. See instructions.	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No
1e Amount paid. See instructions.			

Did you receive
dependent care benefits?☐ **No** Complete only Part II below.☐ **Yes** Complete Part III on page 2 next.

Caution: If the care provider is your household employee, you may owe employment taxes. For details, see the Instructions for Schedule H (Form 1040). If you incurred care expenses in 2026 but didn't pay them until 2027, or if you prepaid in 2026 for care to be provided in 2027, don't include these expenses in column (d) of line 2 for 2026. See the instructions.

Part II Credit for Child and Dependent Care Expenses**2** Information about your **qualifying person(s)**. If you have more than three qualifying persons, see the instructions and check this box ☐

(a) Qualifying person's name		(b) Qualifying person's social security number (see instructions)	(c) Check here if the qualifying person was over age 12 and was disabled. See instructions.	(d) Qualified expenses you incurred and paid in 2026 for the person listed in column (a)
First	Last			
			☐	
			☐	
			☐	

3 Add the amounts in column (d) of line 2. Don't enter more than \$3,000 if you had one qualifying person or \$6,000 if you had two or more persons. If you completed Part III, enter the amount from line 31	3	
4 Enter your earned income . See instructions	4	
5 If married filing jointly, enter your spouse's earned income (if you or your spouse was a student or was disabled, see the instructions); all others , enter the amount from line 4	5	
6 Enter the smallest of line 3, 4, or 5. If zero or less, enter -0-	6	
7 Enter the amount from Form 1040, 1040-SR, or 1040-NR, line 11a	7	
8 Enter on line 8 the decimal amount that applies to the amount on line 7. See instructions for the amount to enter	8	X.
9a Multiply line 6 by the decimal amount on line 8	9a	
9b If you paid 2025 expenses in 2026, complete Worksheet A in the instructions. Enter the amount from line 13 of the worksheet here. Otherwise, enter -0- on line 9b and go to line 9c	9b	
9c Add lines 9a and 9b and enter the result	9c	
10 Tax liability limit. Enter the amount from the Credit Limit Worksheet in the instructions	10	
11 Credit for child and dependent care expenses. Enter the smaller of line 9c or line 10 here and on Schedule 3 (Form 1040), line 2	11	

For Paperwork Reduction Act Notice, see your tax return instructions.

Cat. No. 11862M

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Part III Dependent Care Benefits

12	Enter the total amount of dependent care benefits you received in 2026. Amounts you received as an employee should be shown in box 10 of your Form(s) W-2. Don't include amounts reported as wages in box 1 of Form(s) W-2. If you were self-employed or a partner, include amounts you received under a dependent care assistance program from your sole proprietorship or partnership	12	
13	Enter the amount, if any, you carried over from 2025 and used in 2026 during the grace period. See instructions	13	
14	Enter the amount, if any, you forfeited or carried forward to 2027. See instructions	14	()
15	Combine lines 12 through 14. See instructions	15	
16	Enter the total amount of qualified expenses incurred in 2026 for the care of the qualifying person(s)	16	
17	Enter the smaller of line 15 or 16	17	
18	Enter your earned income . See instructions	18	
19	Enter the amount shown below that applies to you. • If married filing jointly, enter your spouse's earned income (if you or your spouse was a student or was disabled, see the instructions for line 5). • If married filing separately, see instructions. • All others, enter the amount from line 18.	19	
20	Enter the smallest of line 17, 18, or 19. If zero or less, enter -0-	20	
21	Enter \$7,500 (\$3,750 if married filing separately and you were required to enter your spouse's earned income on line 19). However, don't enter more than the maximum amount allowed under your dependent care plan. See instructions	21	
22	Is any amount on line 12 or 13 from your sole proprietorship or partnership? ☐ No. Enter -0-. ☐ Yes. Enter the amount here	22	
23	Subtract line 22 from line 15	23	
24	Deductible benefits. Enter the smallest of line 20, 21, or 22. Also, include this amount on the appropriate line(s) of your return. See instructions	24	
25	Excluded benefits. If you checked "No" on line 22, enter the smaller of line 20 or line 21. Otherwise, subtract line 24 from the smaller of line 20 or line 21. If zero or less, enter -0-	25	
26	Taxable benefits. Subtract line 25 from line 23. If zero or less, enter -0-. Also, enter this amount on Form 1040, 1040-SR, or 1040-NR, line 1e	26	

To claim the child and dependent care credit,
complete lines 27 through 31 below.

27	Enter \$3,000 (\$6,000 if two or more qualifying persons)	27	
28	Add lines 24 and 25	28	
29	Subtract line 28 from line 27. If zero or less, stop . You can't take the credit. Exception. If you paid 2025 expenses in 2026, see the instructions for line 9b	29	
30	Complete line 2 on page 1 of this form. Don't include in column (d) any benefits shown on line 28 above. Then, add the amounts in column (d) and enter the total here	30	
31	Enter the smaller of line 29 or 30. Also, enter this amount on line 3 on page 1 of this form and complete lines 4 through 11	31	